Deploying ClaimSage live

This gets you a **public demo**: the React frontend on Vercel talking to the FastAPI backend on Render, with vectors in managed Qdrant Cloud. All three have free tiers.

```
[ Vercel: frontend ]  --HTTPS-->  [ Render: FastAPI backend ]  -->  [ Qdrant Cloud ]
                                            |
                                            +--> OpenRouter (LLM + embeddings)
```

Steps marked **(you)** need your own accounts/logins; the code and config are already in the repo.

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1. Qdrant Cloud (vector store) — (you)

1. Sign up at https://cloud.qdrant.io and create a **free cluster**.
2. Copy the **cluster URL** (looks like `https://xxxx.cloud.qdrant.io:6333`) and create an **API key**.
3. Keep both handy for step 2.

2. Backend on Render — (you)

1. Push this repo to GitHub (see bottom).
2. In Render: **New** → **Blueprint**, select this repo. Render reads `render.yaml` and creates the `claimsage-api` web service (Docker, from `backend/Dockerfile` — Tesseract for OCR is baked in).
3. Set the service's environment variables (dashboard → Environment):
   - `OPENROUTER_API_KEY` = your `sk-or-v1-...` key
   - `QDRANT_URL` = the Qdrant Cloud URL from step 1
   - `QDRANT_API_KEY` = the Qdrant Cloud API key from step 1
   - `CORS_ORIGINS` = your Vercel URL once you have it (step 3), e.g. `https://claimsage.vercel.app,http://localhost:5173`
4. Deploy. When it's live, verify: `curl https://<your-service>.onrender.com/api/health` → `{"status":"ok"}`. (First request after idle can take ~50s on the free plan — a cold start.)

3. Frontend on Vercel — (you)

1. In Vercel: **Add New** → **Project**, import this repo.
2. Set **Root Directory** to `frontend`. Framework preset: **Vite**.
3. Add an environment variable:
   - `VITE_API_URL` = your Render backend URL (e.g. `https://claimsage-api.onrender.com`)
4. Deploy. Vercel gives you the public link — this is the one for your resume.
5. Go back to Render and make sure `CORS_ORIGINS` includes this exact Vercel URL, then redeploy the backend. The frontend's "Backend unreachable" banner clears.

Notes & limitations

- **Cold starts:** Render's free web service sleeps after ~15 min idle; the first request wakes it (~50s). Fine for a demo; upgrade the plan to remove it.
- **Ephemeral storage:** the SQLite session/document registry and uploaded files live on the instance's disk, which resets on redeploy/sleep. Each visitor just starts a fresh session — vectors themselves persist in Qdrant Cloud. For durable multi-visit history, move the registry to Postgres (future work).
- **Never commit secrets** — all keys are set in the Render/Vercel dashboards.

Pushing this repo to GitHub

```
git remote add origin https://github.com/<you>/ClaimSage.git   # first time
git push -u origin main
```